LOVING YOUR DONORS AND CHAMPIONS

Best Practices for Showing Love

Motivation to Spend More Time Loving Your Donors:
Part 1: People feel good when they give. They have the motivation to be part of something bigger than themselves. Everyone is a Donor!

Part 2: Gratitude has scientifically been shown to be good for one's health! What better thing to give to your Donors than gratitude.

Part 3: Data shows that more than half of your Donors will not give to your organization next year. Only 2/10 first time Donors will give again next year. **People stop giving because they either passed away, they can no longer afford it, or they received poor service or communication.**

While we can't change someone's ability to give, we can control how we work with those people over time. You can continue to love them and keep them involved.

Top 12 Tips

1 Change Your Thinking

- Appropriately balance Donor stewardship and Donor relationship activities. Stewardship activities are done in service to fulfill the promises made to the Donor. Relationship activities are things to nurture the connection.

2 Thank Early and Often

- Monitor donations closely. Call, email or text people as they give during Early Giving and on the day of Give Miami Day.
- Take this opportunity to strengthen your relationship with your Donor. Have a team member with a close connection to the Donor reach out and give them a heartfelt thank you that touches on the immediate impact of their gift.

3 Thank Again on Friday

- Send additional appreciation notes to Donors and Supporters after Give Miami Day. No gift is too small; personalize your communications.
- Communicate with your Donors as though they were your friends and family not just transactions.

4 Provide Updates Quickly

- Tell Donors what their gifts will accomplish the day of their donation and the day after. At the end of the year thank them again.
- Share updates with Champions; what their efforts raised and how it will impact your mission.

5 Use Video

- Create and send a video that can pertain to every Donor. Separate videos can be created for different Donor categories, like those that donate a higher amount.
- Videos can be phone recorded, or you can use services like BombBomb and ThankView.
- Record pre GMD videos that include a soft ask talking about the impact of a Donor's gift. After GMD, have a team member with the closest relationship to the Donor send a personalized video specifically about their donation.

6 Grab Bag to Thank Champions

- Name Champions (with pictures) in your newsletter.
- Send a dedicated email publicly thanking Champions.
- Send and or post Thank Yous on social media.
- Send Branded items / swag boxes to Champions.
- Throw events and gatherings to invite Champions during GMD week, like a Happy Hour or brunch.

7 Welcome New Donors

- Welcome and thank new Donors brought in by Give Miami Day. Create a first time Donor welcome email series with the goal of bringing the Donor closer and informing them about your organization.
- Send 3 emails in total every other week or more, with the first being a Thank You and all of them including more information about your organization.
- If possible, use a CRM system to automate sending out these emails.
- This is a great practice to do year round not just with Give Miami Day.

8 Quarterly Impact Reports

- Opt for creating Quarterly Impact Reports over annual reports as they are more effective. Focus on how gifts made a difference to your mission and constituents. Share data and accompanying stories.

9 Donors Only Events

- Create Donors-only experiences. Do an activity that is appropriate to your mission and budget to bring Donors together and thank them.
- Create separate events based on Donor categories, like for higher dollar Donors.
- These events become cultivation opportunities. Think smaller more intimate gatherings to nurture relationships.

10 Engage Your Champions

- After Give Miami Day, ask your Champions questions about their experience. What worked well? What could be improved? How can we make the experience easier next year? They will appreciate being asked and you can implement their answers into next year's plan.

11 Invite to Give Again

- Engage with your Supporters more than just on Give Miami Day. People will give to your cause more than once a year. So ask them.

12 Adopt a Mindset

- Surprise and delight your Donors! When are those moments you can surprise people, make them feel seen, and do something out of the ordinary?

Questions and Information

Reach out to givemiamiday@miamifoundation.org

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